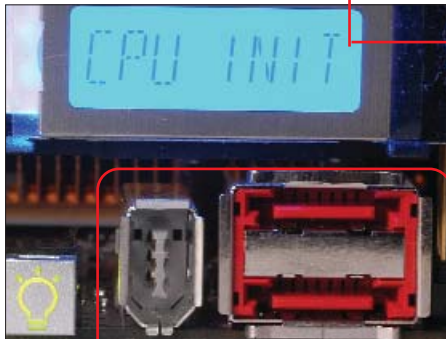


The Enthusiast's Motherboard

Heatpipe Cooling: Though not really a feature, nor as effective as an air-cooling solution, heatpipe cooling is nonetheless very desirable because it does away with fan noise. Heat dissipated by chipsets are absorbed by the heatsink fins, and whisked away by the heatpipes (through thermal convection) to eventually be dissipated by the CPU fan. Essential for a quiet computing experience, and also helps minimise dust buildup. Another plus point is no worrying about fan failure.

POST LCD: Enthusiast boards have some form of diagnostic on the motherboard itself—either a hex code display, or something like this, which gives you a clear view of where exactly the problem lies in case of a failed boot. A very nifty addition, especially if you're not paying extra for it!



E-SATA and FireWire Ports: One of the in things for a motherboard to have these days, external SATA allows you to hook up your serial ATA drive just like a USB drive, except for the blazing speeds that the Serial ATA interface allows. FireWire connects aren't uncommon for a motherboard these days, and are not one of the “pay extra for” features anymore. You have every right to demand a motherboard with these connects!

